Glamorous: Showy

Worthwhile = Important/ worth your time

Sanctuary: Safe space

Sanctions: Rules

Read **Text B** and answer **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text B: Volunteering to work with animals

In this online article, a conservation expert gives his opinion on animal sanctuaries – places that take care of animals – and on volunteering to work in them.

Conserve: Save

ad = advertisement

'Lots of young people want to give up their free time to help support conservation,' claims an advert online, citing 2 900 searches for 'conservation volunteering' last month. This must add up to tens of thousands of hours of effort from volunteers every year, and impressive levels of fundraising and donations to make it possible. With all this money and effort, conservation should really go places. 'Surely that's a success story?' some would argue. But that donated money could do a great deal more.

Go places = To be successful.

In all honesty, every time someone comes up to me after a talk and says they want to help conservation, so they are (obviously) heading off to (a) an elephant orphanage, (b) a primate sanctuary or (c) work with big cats, my heart sinks. 'There's nothing more dispiriting than people who think that they are helping,' agrees conservationist Rita Ni, who manages a sanctuary which runs a captive breeding and reintroduction programme (the gold standard of working with animals), 'but they really aren't.'

Dispiriting: Off-putting

That may sound unnecessarily harsh, but conservation is harsh. It's unforgiving. For me personally, saving individual animals should always come second to saving species, which in turn comes second to protecting and managing habitats – infinitely less glamorous, but undoubtedly more worthwhile. Often, some of the most successful conservation strategies actually involve exterminating invasive species. Sounds horrible? It is, and so undesirable that, unsurprisingly, no conservation organisation has ever presented that opportunity to potential volunteers.

keen / excited

On the other hand, a growing number of so-called 'animal sanctuaries' are realising that well-meaning, eager volunteers can help keep them in business, through exploiting people's passion for a cute animal. Even among the well-established sanctuaries, there are few which do anything to solve the root cause of the problem – the reason that injured and homeless animals end up there in the first place.

To against your word

Keeping any animal in captivity is expensive – that explains where all of your donations go. But, hey, you get to take that baby elephant down for a wash, or bottle-feed that orphaned orangutan and feel good about yourself. I am of course a hypocrite – I would relish the chance to do those things. But I resist, not least because I'm aware of the environmental impact of flying to a remote sanctuary.

Enjoy

'Where reintroduction is a key aim,' Rita Ni explains, 'a hands-off approach from keepers and volunteers is required, with less direct contact.' This, unfortunately, it seems is the opposite of what 'sells' volunteering opportunities to young people. Of course, I wouldn't want to cast doubt on some of the fantastic projects that exist and to make it harder for organisations like Rita Ni's to raise funds.

Any responsible sanctuary will be able to answer vital questions such as: What is your long-term plan? Are your animals released into the wild wherever possible? And of course, what safety precautions do you have? Koalas may look like cute and cuddly teddy bears, but they are wild animals.

So who's at fault? I believe the responsibility lies with conservation organisations who should be educating volunteers about what to look for, rather than promoting 'cute and cuddly' experiences. Typically, organisations recruit volunteers to work for such a short time that the difference they can make is likely to be insignificant anyway.

By the way, just for the sake of comparison, here are a few other things young people searched for: 'fake tan' = 14 800, 'pet chimps' = 1 000 and 'gap year' = 49 500.

Significant: Important

Jaweria Amer

→ capital

1. Money/donations could be better used elsewhere

yield

Funds could be directed toward more effective conservation methods.
Financial resources might achieve greater impact if used differently.
Raising money may be more beneficial than volunteering time.

2. Volunteers prefer popular or "cute" animals

= big/large

Most volunteers choose to work with attractive or famous species like elephants or primates.
People often select animals that appear endearing rather than endangered.
Volunteers favour working with large, appealing creatures instead of lesser-known species.

3. Sanctuaries encourage cute/cuddly experiences

Wildlife centres promote affectionate encounters rather than genuine protection.
Many sanctuaries market emotional or photogenic interactions to attract volunteers.
Such organisations prioritise tourist-like experiences over real conservation.

4. Volunteers make little or no difference

Their presence rarely produces meaningful outcomes for animals.
The work done by volunteers has minimal long-term impact.
Volunteering seldom brings about real improvements in animal welfare.

5. Saving individual animals is not a priority

Focusing on single animals is considered a low priority.
Conservation experts see rescuing individual creatures as less important.
Isolated rescues do not contribute significantly to larger conservation aims.

solitary
single
lone

6. Protecting species or habitats is more useful

It is more valuable to preserve entire species and ecosystems.
Long-term success comes from conserving habitats, not individual animals.
Managing the environment as a whole is seen as more beneficial.

7. Volunteers avoid unpleasant conservation work

Few volunteers wish to handle unappealing or harsh conservation tasks.
They are reluctant to engage in difficult duties such as extermination or disease control.
Most choose glamorous roles instead of essential but unpleasant ones.

8. Sanctuaries exploit volunteers for profit

Some organisations use volunteers mainly as a source of income.
Sanctuaries depend on volunteers to stay financially stable.
These centres exploit volunteer labour to sustain their operations.

9. Few sanctuaries address the real causes of the problem

Most facilities ignore the root causes of animal endangerment.
They focus on surface-level care instead of long-term solutions.
The underlying environmental issues are rarely tackled.

10. Flying to sanctuaries harms the environment

Air travel to these locations adds to carbon emissions.
Visiting sanctuaries increases the volunteer's ecological footprint.
Travelling long distances contributes to environmental damage.

11. Volunteers prefer direct contact, though it's unnecessary

Many want hands-on interaction even when indirect work is more effective.
They prefer handling animals despite it not being required.
Physical involvement appeals to volunteers, though minimal contact is advised.

12. Volunteers are not properly educated

They receive little or no conservation training.
Many lack awareness about ecological or ethical practices.
Instead of learning, they are given tasks without proper explanation.

13. Volunteers only work briefly

Their stay is short, limiting the impact they can make.
Most participate for a limited period before leaving.
The temporary nature of their involvement reduces its usefulness.

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Section B

Read **Text B**, ***Volunteering to work with animals***, in the insert and answer **Question 3**.

= Negatives

Question 3

(a) Summarise the arguments against volunteering to work with animals, according to Text B.

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form).

Use your own words as far as possible.

Avoid copying long sections of the text.

Your summary should be no more than 150 words.

Meat = disadvantages

Automatically, advantages of veganism

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

(1) The funds could be put to better uses.

Volunteers who think that they are helping but they really aren't

(2) Volunteers are deluded to believe their work is beneficial

= volunteers' effort does not yield any results.

(3) Volunteers only want cute experiences // volunteers merely wish to work with endearing animals.

↳ Something that attracts love

(4) Protecting populations should be preferred to single animals. //

Volunteers ' prioritize protecting solitary animals rather than entire populations.

Gore // scary

(5) // Atrocious conservation chances are not given to them.

· Merely: Just

Jaweria Amer

Volunteering to work with animals is an avenue that does not yield any real outputs. Not only do volunteers **merely** want cute experiences, but also they avoid the more prosperous conservation chances owing to the lack of glamour. Most organizations only use volunteers as a source of profit; whereas these financial resources could be directed to achieve a bigger impact. Moreover, most facilities neglect the base reasons of the issue. These centers prioritize saving solitary animals over entire populations in tandem with their actual habitats – which is the wrong approach. Additionally, the air travel to some isolated sanctuaries is a threat in itself; conclusively, the fact that volunteers receive little to no conservation training coupled with their short working spans make the problem skyrocket. [20]

topic

(b) Imagine you are conservationist Rita Ni.

You are interviewed by a journalist about your work with animals.

Give your answer to the journalist's question, using information from the text.

Journalist's question: Some people think that sanctuaries like yours are irresponsible and exploit animals and volunteers.

What is your opinion and why?

Rita Ni's answer:

Disagree

..... [5]

[Total: 25]

Question 3(a)

This question tests the following reading assessment objectives (10 marks)

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings
R5 select and use information for specific purposes

and the following writing assessment objectives (10 marks)

W2 organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect
W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
3(a)	**Summarise the arguments against volunteering to work with animals, according to Text B.** **You must <u>use continuous writing</u> (not note form).** **Use your own words as far as possible.** **Avoid copying long sections of the text.** **Your summary should be no more than 150 words.** **<u>Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.</u>** Use the Marking Criteria for **Question 3** (Table **R**, **Reading** and Table **W**, **Writing**). **INDICATIVE READING CONTENT** Candidates may refer to any of the points below: 1 money / donations / fundraising could do more / be put to better use	**20**	

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
3(a)	2 (volunteers) want the cute / popular animals / big cats / elephants / primates // (sanctuaries) promote / encourage cute / cuddly experiences 3 (volunteers / they) aren't helping // (volunteers / they) don't make a difference 4 saving / focusing on individual animals is not a priority / worthwhile 5 saving species is (more) worthwhile / useful 6 protecting / managing habitats is (more) worthwhile / useful 7 volunteers are not offered / do not want to do less glamorous / horrible conservation strategies / extermination 8 sanctuaries exploit / use volunteers (to keep them in business) 9 sanctuaries / they don't try to solve (the cause of) the problem // few sanctuaries try to solve the problem 10 the environmental impact of flying / using non eco-friendly transport (to go to a sanctuary) 11 hands off approach / less direct contact is required // volunteers want to handle the animals 12 volunteers are not being educated // they should be educating / explaining to volunteers 13 volunteers work for a short time		

Question 3(b)

This question tests the following reading assessment objective (5 marks)

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

Candidates should use some of the following text details about Rita Ni / responsible sanctuaries as guidance / prompts:

Paragraph 2

- 'There's nothing more dispiriting than **people who think that they are helping**,' agrees conservationist **Rita Ni, who manages a sanctuary which runs a captive breeding and reintroduction programme (the gold standard of working with animals)**, '**but they really aren't**.'

Paragraph 5

- '**Keeping any animal in captivity is expensive** – that explains where all of your donations go'.

Paragraph 6

- '**Where reintroduction is a key aim,' Rita Ni explains, 'a hands-off approach** from keepers and volunteers **is required, with less direct contact**.' This, unfortunately, it seems is the opposite to what 'sells' volunteering opportunities to young people. Of course, I wouldn't want to cast doubts on some of the **fantastic projects that exist and to make it harder for organisations like Rita Ni's to raise funds.**

Paragraph 7

- **Any responsible sanctuary will be able to answer vital questions** such as: What is your **long-term plan**? Are your **animals released into the wild** wherever possible? And of course, what **safety precautions** do you have?

Paragraph 8

- I believe the **responsibility** lies with conservation organisations who should be **educating volunteers** about what to look for, rather than promoting 'cute and cuddly' experiences.

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
3(b)	**<u>Imagine you are conservationist Rita Ni</u>.** **You are interviewed by a journalist about your work with animals.** **Give your answer to the journalist's question, using information from the text.** **<u>Journalist's question</u>: Some people think that sanctuaries like yours are irresponsible and exploit animals and volunteers**. **What is your opinion and why?**	**5**	

<table>
<tr><th>Question</th><th>Answer</th><th>Marks</th><th>Guidance</th></tr>
<tr><td>3(b)</td><td>

INDICATIVE CONTENT
Relevant perspective: Rita Ni believes that sanctuaries like hers are responsible / do not exploit animals and volunteers.

Responses might use any of the following ideas / details:

<table>
<tr><th>Supporting text details ✓</th><th>Development DEV</th></tr>
<tr><td>

- **1. Rita Ni's fantastic / gold standard projects // captive breeding and reintroduction programme**
- **2. has a hands-off approach / less direct contact**
- **3. dispiriting to see volunteers not really helping (at other sanctuaries)**
- **4. responsible sanctuaries have long term plans**
- **5. there is a need for funds /harder for her to raise funds**
- **6. responsible sanctuaries educate volunteers**

</td><td>

- priority is increasing animal numbers rather than volunteer experience / helps ensure species do not become at risk / focus is on a species rather than an individual anima
- may not be what volunteers want but this makes reintroduction easier / animal welfare more important than satisfying volunteers' desire for contact
- makes sure volunteers are used effectively / volunteers are educated about the bigger picture such as saving species / volunteers are not to be seen as profit-making

</td></tr>
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Developments in the MS are suggestions, candidates may offer alternative creditworthy developments about Rita, her sanctuary or 'responsible sanctuaries

</td></tr>
</table>

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
3(b)	• reintroduction programme takes a long time / don't recruit volunteers for a short time only • cannot afford bad publicity around other sanctuaries (because keeping animals in captivity is expensive)/ Rita Ni would not risk damaging reputation • will not be giving in to the demand for stereotypical, cute and cuddly experiences / will teach volunteers about what endangers wildlife		